



Foldable phones shouldn't feel like an experiment

That's what Motorola India MD **TM Narasimhan** believes

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Moto Razr Fold is Motorola's first book-style foldable phone in India. But, the company's journey with foldable phones began years ago, when it revived the iconic Razr brand in 2019 and became one of the first mainstream brands to bet big on foldable smartphones. While competitors rushed, Motorola waited, intentionally.

In an exclusive chat, TM Narasimhan, Managing Director, Motorola India, spoke about the company's approach towards foldable phones.

"When Moto does something, it has to be truly innovative and solve a real consumer need," Narasimhan said. "We always had the technology. The problem was whether we could deliver the experience consumers actually wanted."

That philosophy explains a lot about Motorola's first book-style foldable. The Moto Razr Fold never tried to be the first foldable in the market. Instead, Motorola wants it to feel like the first foldable you can confidently use as your primary phone.

No longer feel like compromises

For Narasimhan, the biggest problem with foldables until now has been compromise. Smaller batteries, cameras that were never as good as slab phones, durability concerns, visible creases and even weak hinges. Consumers were paying flagship money but still settling for less in some areas.

"Anybody spending that kind of money wants the best camera possible and a battery that lasts," he

explained. "Those were the two biggest pain points we saw."

According to him, the timing finally made sense because the technology caught up. The Moto Razr Fold uses a 6,000mAh silicon-anode battery, something Motorola believes solves one of the biggest complaints users have had with foldables for years.

Narasimhan confidently claimed that for most people, the phone should comfortably last one to two days. Just as importantly, Motorola says the camera system inside the Razr Fold is the same one being used in its flagship Moto Signature, instead of a downgraded setup often seen on foldables.

Motorola isn't trying to kill the slab phone

Interestingly, one of the most refreshing moments in the conversation came when the discussion shifted toward whether foldables are meant to replace traditional flagship slab phones. Most executives would aggressively push foldables as the future. Narasimhan did the opposite.

"Frankly, I wouldn't convince anyone," he said when asked how he would convince a flagship smartphone user to switch to a foldable.

For him, foldables are not replacements, they are choices. Some people prefer candy-bar phones. Some prefer flip phones. Some will prefer book-style foldables. Motorola believes that they should simply build strong products across categories and let consumers decide for themselves.

When I asked him "Who is this phone for?" He replied "Anybody who loves good technology. This targets both productivity and lifestyle." He pauses, then makes a point that is simple but cuts through a lot of the noise around foldables. "Tell me one person who doesn't check email on their phone. Tell me one person who doesn't flaunt their phone."

"Consumer is the king at the end of the day. Let the consumer choose." **d**